

NovaPay

Documentation Gaps & Recommendations



Reviewed against: NovaPay Technical Documentation v1.0 (14 July 2026)

Prepared: 15 July 2026

This review covers the NovaPay v1.0 technical documentation. The existing document is strong on architecture, API surface, database schema, and phased delivery. The items below are areas not currently covered that a coding agent, auditor, or onboarding engineer would likely need before building on or against this system.

1. Compliance & Risk

RISK

- AML/CFT transaction monitoring rules and sanctions screening (e.g. OFAC, local watchlists)
- Per-tier transaction limits — daily/monthly caps by KYC tier, not just the tier_0 restriction
- Fraud detection and velocity checks on payments, cards, and payouts
- Data retention and privacy policy, including NDPR (Nigeria Data Protection Act) compliance specifics
- Dispute and chargeback process for virtual card transactions

2. Money & Pricing

MONEY

- Fee structure — transaction fees, FX margin disclosure shown to end users, card issuance/maintenance fees
- Live exchange rate provider — the doc only shows a static FX_USD_NGN_MID env var, not a production rate source
- Reconciliation process between the internal ledger and payment rail (Flutterwave) settlement reports

3. API Details

API

- Standard error response format/codes — none shown in the current endpoint tables
- Rate limiting policy for public and authenticated endpoints
- Pagination parameters and response shape for list endpoints
- OpenAPI/Swagger spec reference or link
- Idempotency key implementation details — header name, scope, and TTL

4. Infrastructure & Operations

INFRA

- CI/CD pipeline description
- Monitoring, alerting, and observability beyond the basic /health endpoint
- Backup and disaster recovery plan
- Production secrets management (env vars are fine locally, but what handles this in prod?)
- Database indexing strategy and migration rollback plan
- Production card issuer integration — currently mock-only; which processor ships to production (e.g. Marqeta, Union54)?

5. Mobile Application

MOBILE

- Push notification setup and provider
- Offline / poor-connectivity handling, relevant given the target user base
- App store submission and release process (iOS App Store, Google Play)
- Analytics and crash reporting tooling
- Localization — multi-language and multi-country support beyond NGN

6. Testing

TEST

- No test strategy section — unit, integration, and end-to-end test coverage and tooling